Implementation of CUI in *Big Basket*

Project Overview

Online grocery shopping is convenient, but meal planning is not.
Users often know what they want to cook, not the exact ingredients required. Current grocery apps are designed around products, forcing users to manually search for each item, compare options, and add them individually.
This project explores a recipe-driven shopping experience where users can simply state the dish they want to cook and instantly receive all required ingredients in their cart.

Current Shopping *Challenges.*

BigBasket's product focused shopping flow assumes users already know the exact ingredients they need, even though many people **don't know the recipe or required ingredients for certain dishes**, forcing them to **search externally and add items one by one** making meal based shopping **slow, fragmented, and cognitively demanding.**

Why This Problem Matters

Meal-based shopping is common, especially for:
- Beginners learning to cook
- Students living away from home
- Busy professionals
- People trying new cuisines
- Elderly users
- Users cooking for guests

Voice and chat-based shopping are becoming part of everyday life

Opportunity

Opportunity to make the shopping experience faster and more convenient.

Heuristic Evaluation

Before implementing a conversational assistant, we reviewed BigBasket's existing shopping experience to identify usability gaps. The evaluation revealed several friction points in **product discovery**, **decision-making**, and overall navigation that impact how quickly users can shop.

1. The current flow requires users to search and add ingredients individually for a single recipe. This is repetitive and slow for "power users" who already know what they need.
2. Users have to remember every single ingredient needed for a dish while navigating different categories. This increases "Cognitive Load".
3. People often shop based on a "meal plan" or a "recipe," but most apps are organized by "aisles" or "categories".
4. When adding items one by one, it is easy to forget an essential ingredient (like salt or a specific spice) until the checkout phase or after the delivery arrives.
5. Most modern food and grocery apps are moving toward "bundle" logic or "frequently bought together" patterns, but BigBasket still largely relies on a traditional "search-and-select" model.

Competitor Advantages

Amazon Fresh — Alexa integration for reordering & shopping lists.

JioMart — conversational ordering via WhatsApp.

Flipkart — AI voice assistant in Hindi & English

Solution

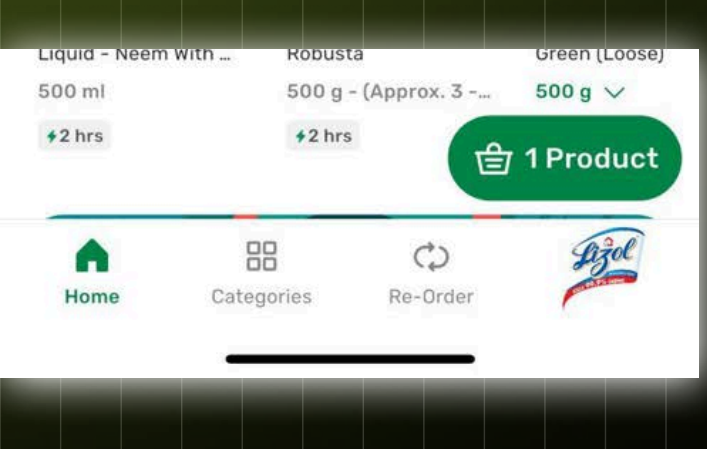
Recipe → Ingredient List → Cart

Users simply describe the dish and number of servings.
The system automatically prepares a ready-to-order ingredient bundle.

Key Features

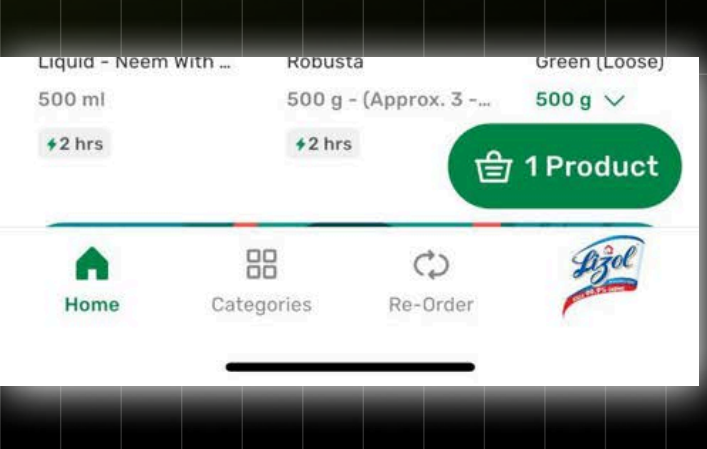
1. **Automatic Ingredient Generation**
No need to know the recipe beforehand.
2. **Serving-Based Scaling**
Quantities adjust automatically for group size.
3. **One-Tap Add All to Cart**
Eliminates repetitive searching.
4. **Editable Ingredient List**
Users can remove items they already have.
5. **Suggested Alternatives**
System recommends available products.
6. **Reduced Navigation**
Entire task completed without browsing categories.

Nav Redesign



Existing Tab Bar

The existing tab bar in BigBasket consists of **four main elements.** A **Home** button, a **Categories** button, a **Re-order** button, and a dedicated space for **promotions**.



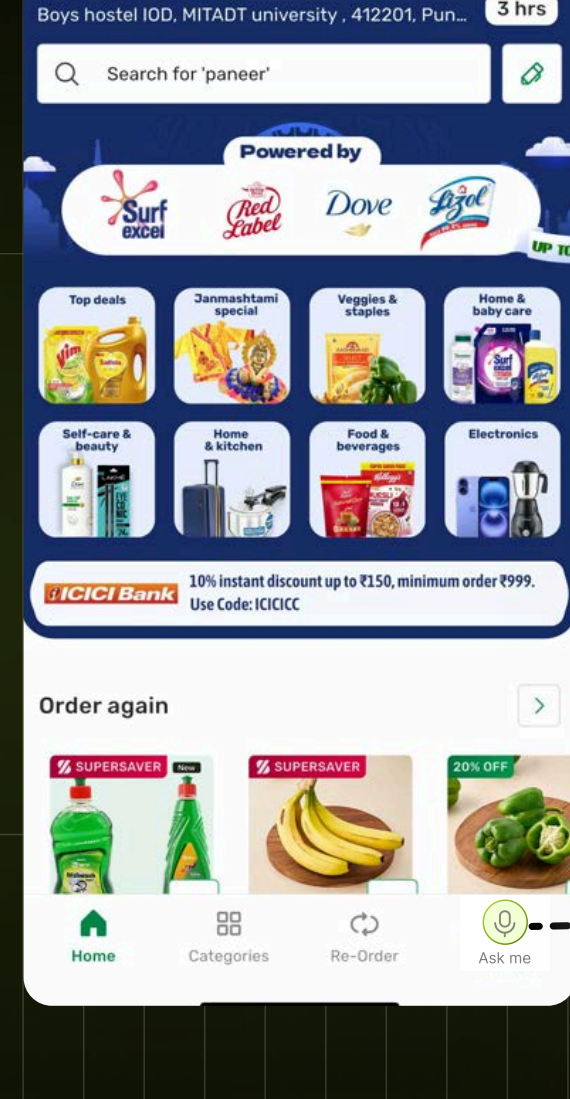
Updated Tab Bar

The updated tab bar is designed to seamlessly integrate with BigBasket's existing UI without disrupting the current layout. In this version, the promotion section is repositioned to the center, and the CUI is implemented in its place, allowing users to interact more intuitively while still retaining the familiar Home, Categories, and Reorder options.

Flow

explains how the new feature helps the user to order items according to specific dishes.

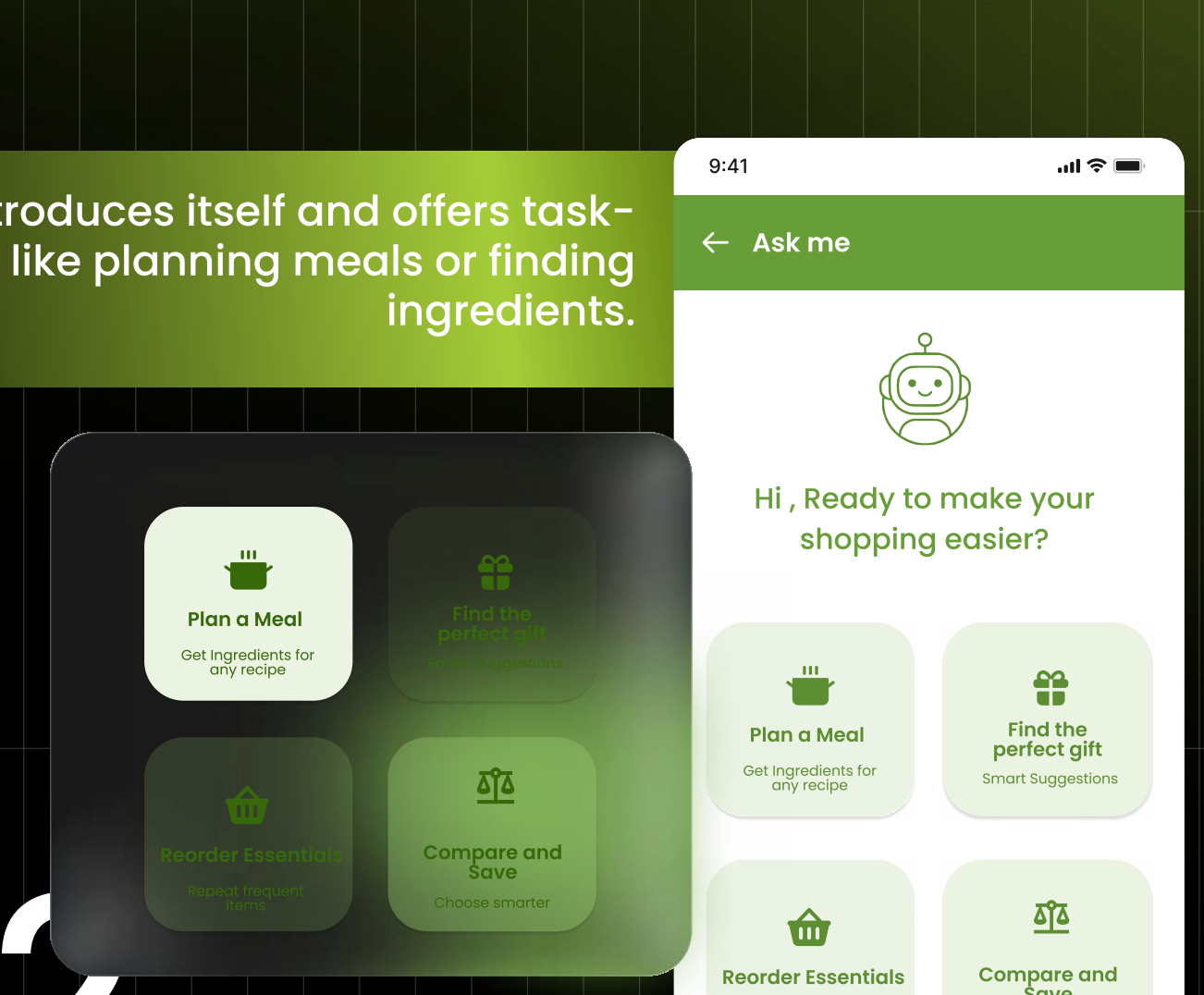
01.



The user launches the app and can access the new "Ask Me" chatbot feature from the home interface.

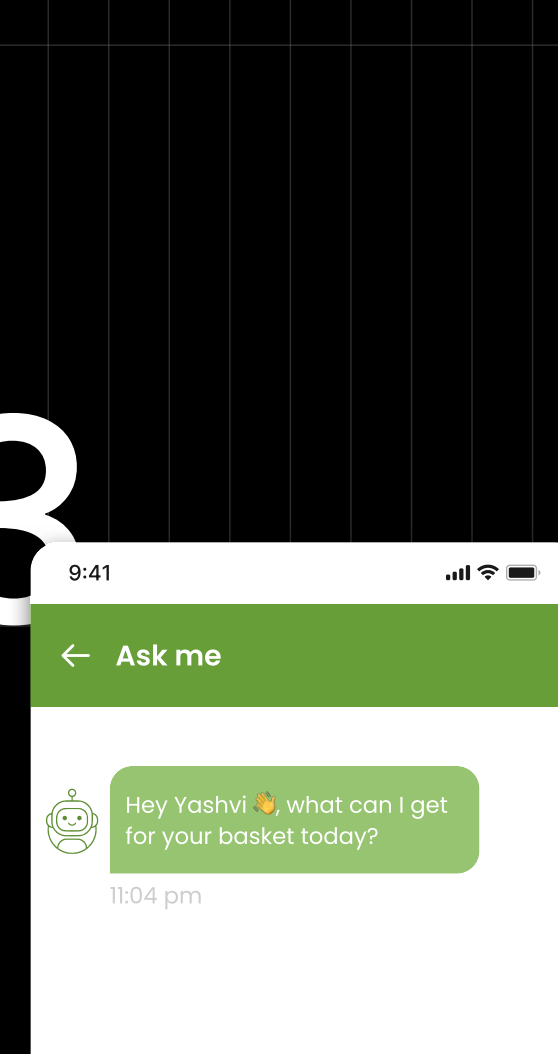
02.

The chatbot introduces itself and offers task-based options like planning meals or finding ingredients.



Hi , Ready to make your shopping easier?

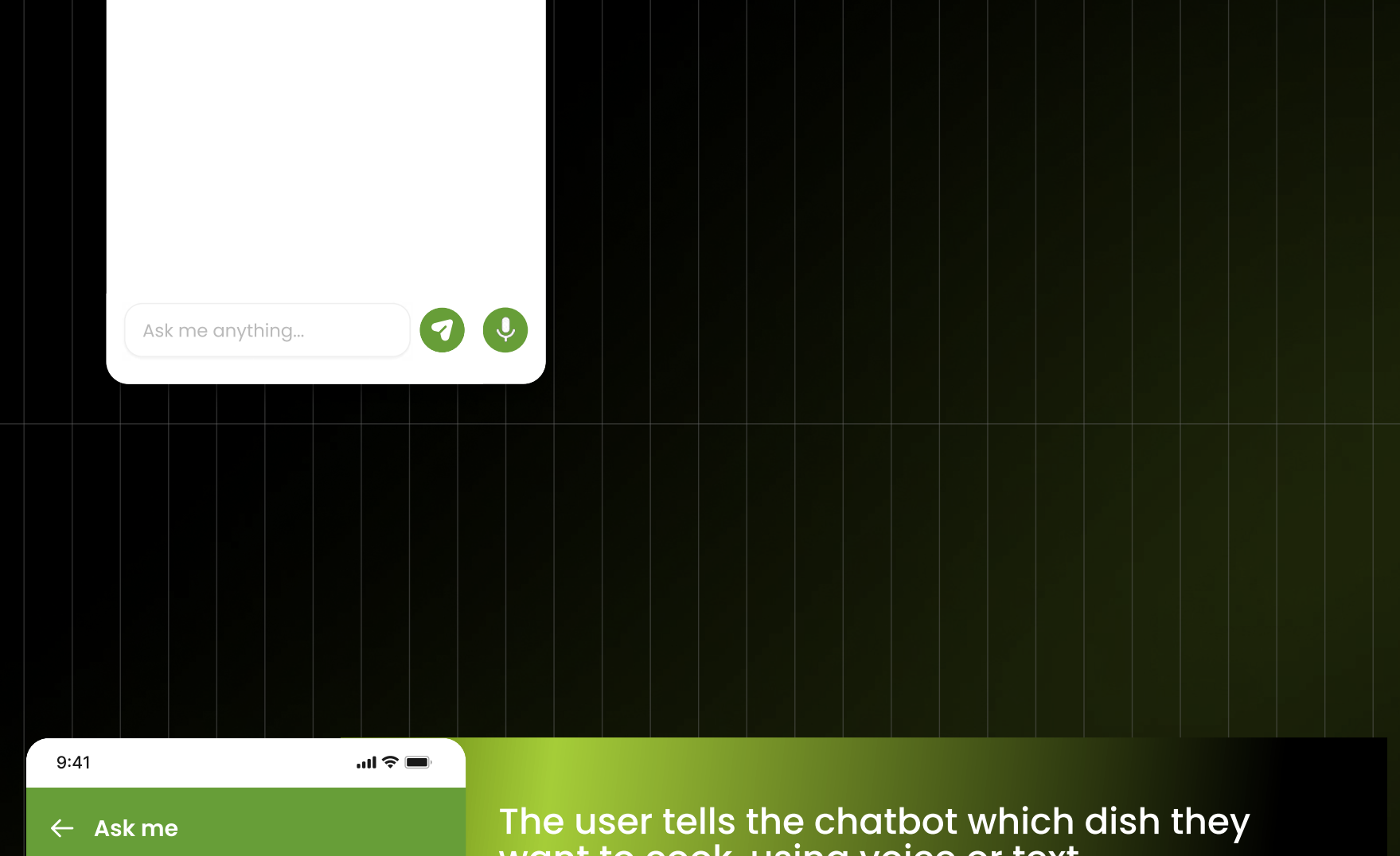
03



Hey Yashvi 👋, what can I get for your basket today?
11:04 pm

The chatbot asks what dish or help they need today.

04.

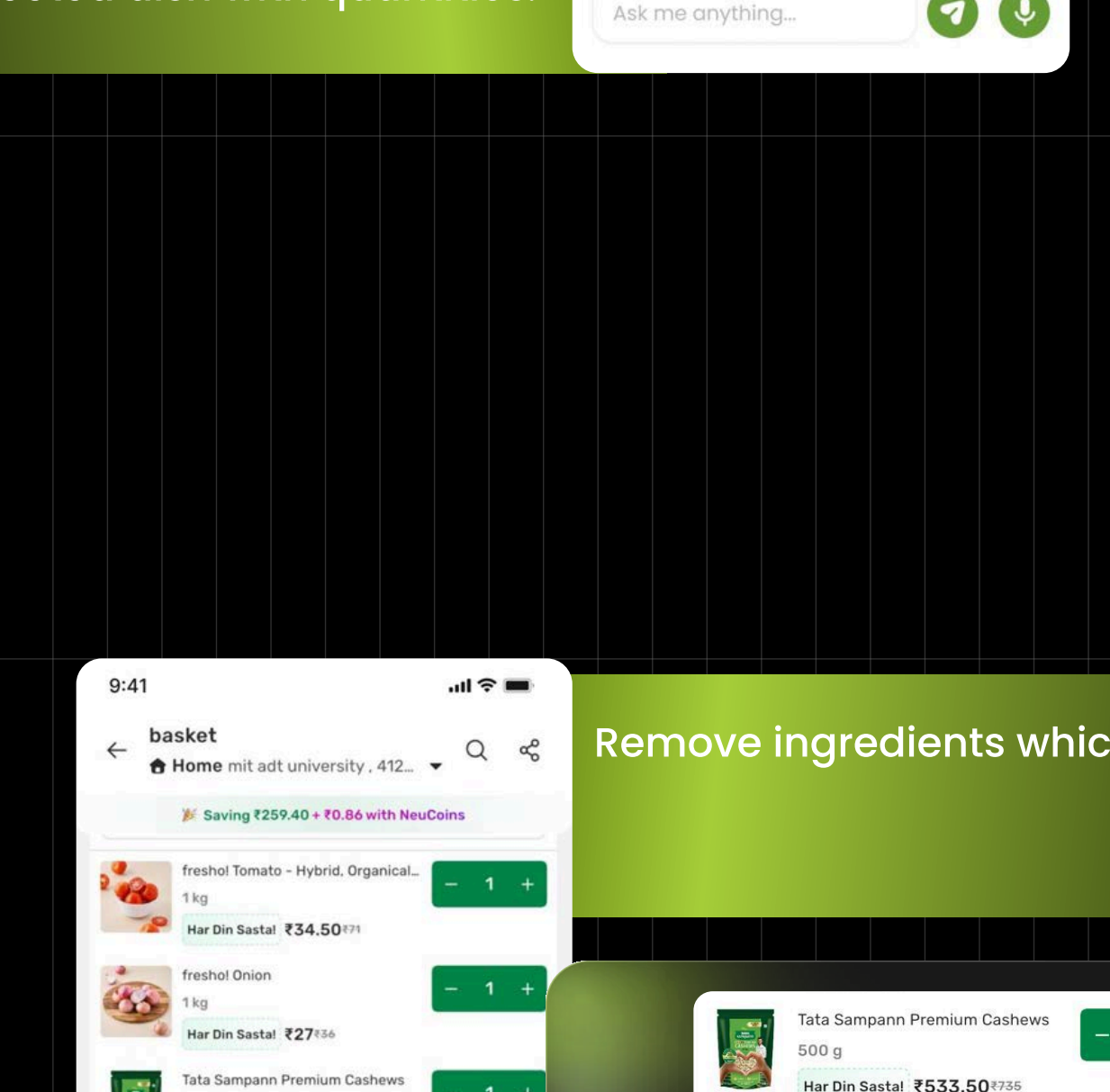


I want to make Paneer Butter Masala for 4 people

The user tells the chatbot which dish they want to cook, using voice or text.

"Listening"

05

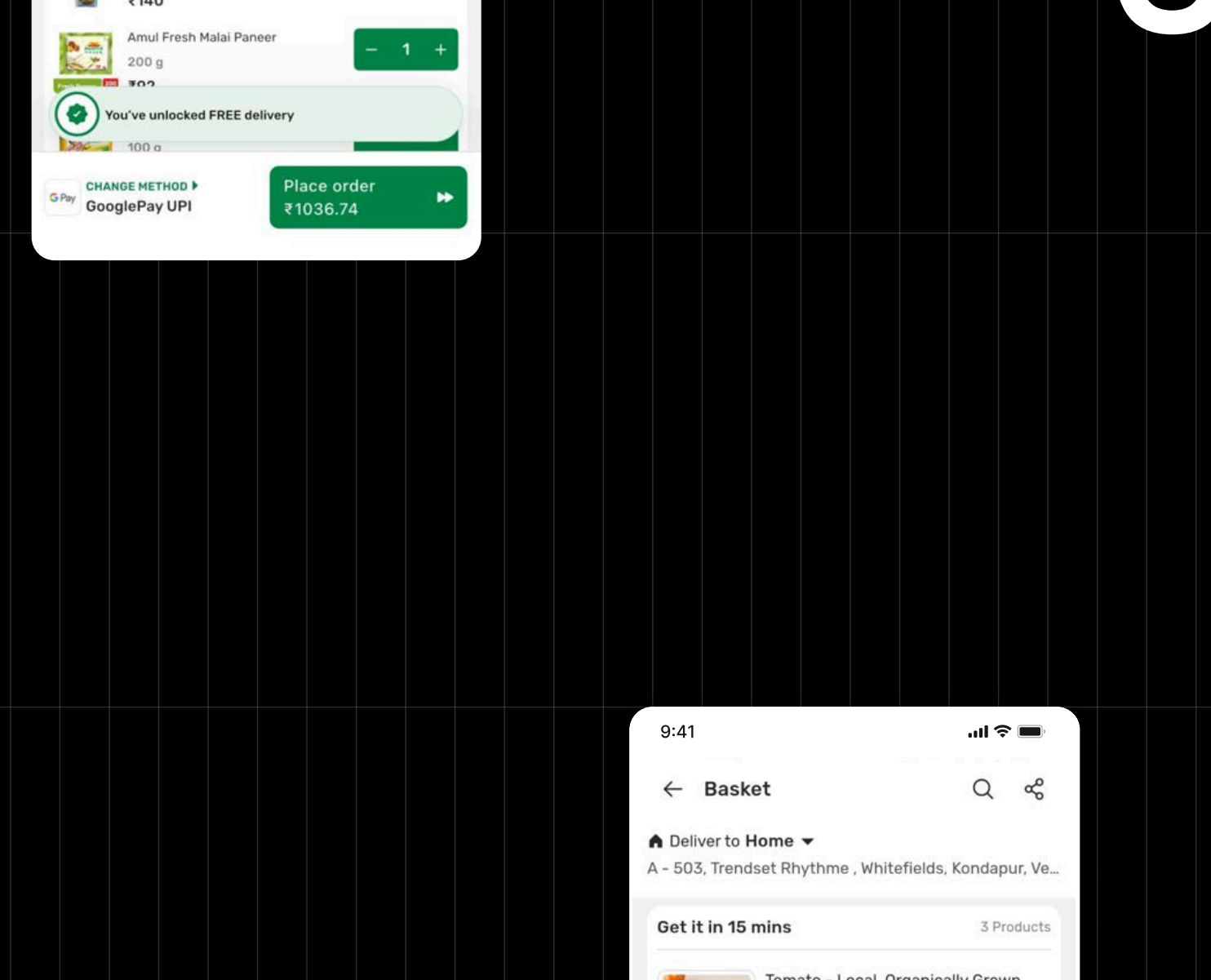


Here are the ingredients you will need. I have scaled them for serving of 4.
11:04 pm

Fresh Malai Paneer 200 g ₹86.0
Fresh Cream 250 ml ₹70.0
Tomato - Local 500 g ₹32.0

The chatbot automatically fetches and displays all required ingredients for the selected dish with quantities.

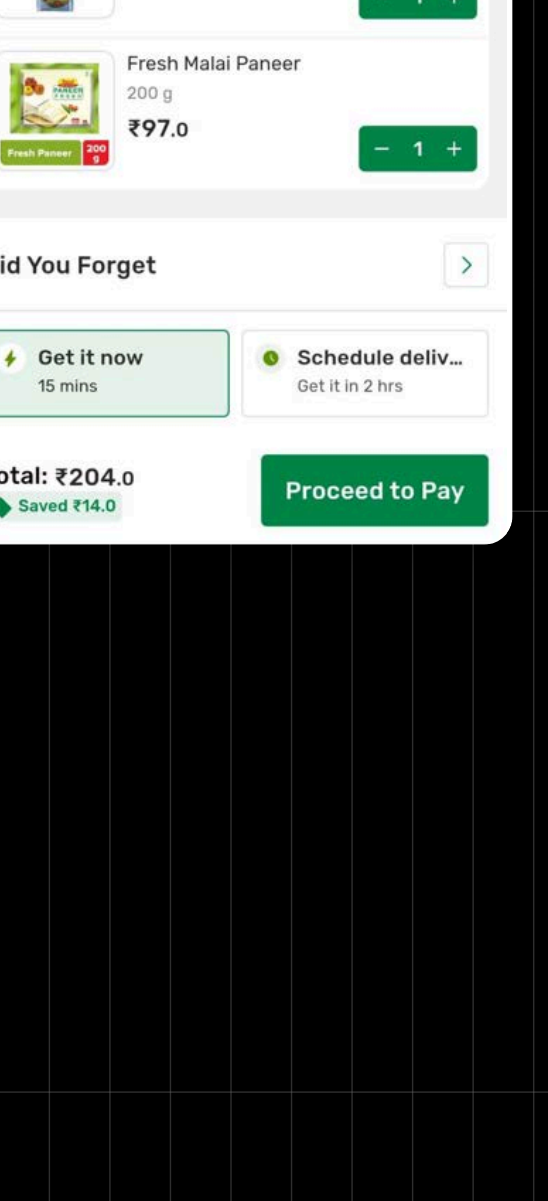
06.



Freshol Tomato - Hybrid, Organical... 1 kg ₹34.50
Freshol Onion 1 kg ₹27
Tata Sampann Premium Cashews 500 g ₹533.50
Aashirvaad Atta/Gavhache Peeth ... 1 kg ₹77.60
Amul Masti Dahi 1 kg ₹100
Amul Fresh Cream 250 ml ₹140
Amul Fresh Malai Paneer 200 g
You've unlocked FREE delivery
Place order ₹1036.74

Remove ingredients which you don't need

07.



Deliver to Home
A - 503, Trendset Rhythme , Whitefields, Kondapur, Ve...
Get it in 15 mins 3 Products
Tomato - Local, Organically Grown (Loose) 500 g ₹37.0
Fresh Cream 250 ml ₹70.0
Fresh Malai Paneer 200 g ₹97.0
Did You Forget
Get it now 15 mins
Schedule deliv... Get it in 2 hrs
Total: ₹204.0 Saved ₹14.0
Proceed to Pay

The user sees all the auto-added items in the cart, completing the dish-based ordering journey triggered by the chatbot.

Why This Matters

This approach reduces:

- Time spent searching
- Decision fatigue
- Navigation complexity
- Cart abandonment
- Cognitive load

It also improves accessibility by enabling voice interaction and guided decision-making.

Impact Potential

If implemented, this feature could:

- Reduce shopping time significantly
- Increase average order value (full meal purchases)
- Encourage users to cook new dishes
- Reduce cart abandonment
- Improve satisfaction and retention
- Differentiate BigBasket from competitors

THANK YOU

Srikshan Sethu Suhani Rajoria Tanbir Kashyap Yashvi Parekh